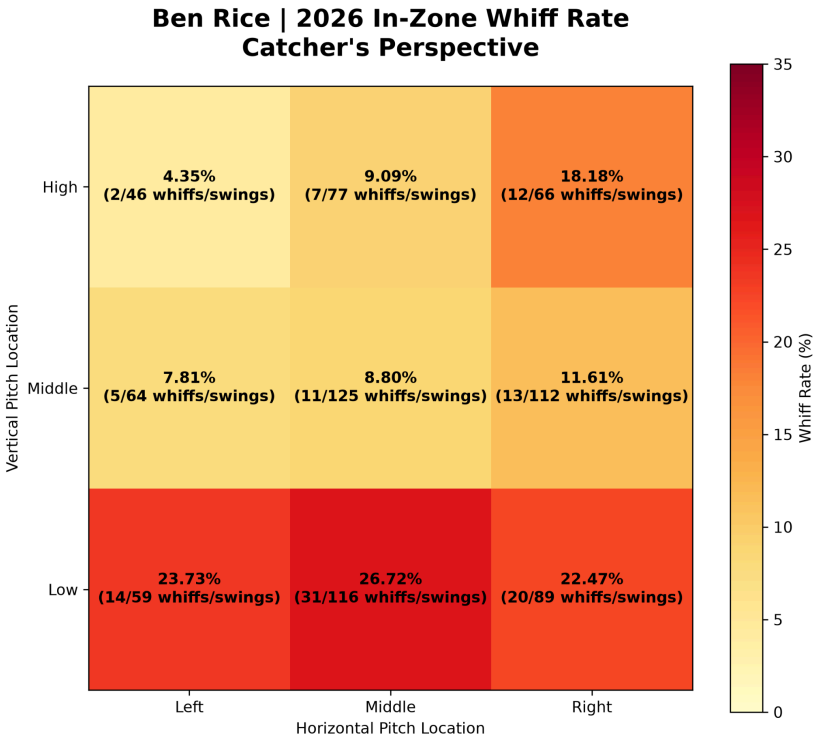
ADVANCE SCOUTING / HITTER MATCHUP REPORT

BEN RICE | 2026

STATCAST ANALYSIS

2,695	1,157	294	25.41%
PITCHES	SWINGS	WHIFFS	WHIFF RATE

01 / IN-ZONE SWING-AND-MISS PROFILE



LOCATION FINDINGS

LOW THIRD | 24.62%
65 whiffs / 264 swings

MIDDLE THIRD | 9.97%
29 whiffs / 291 swings

BELOW ZONE | 54.50%
109 whiffs / 200 swings

BELOW-ZONE SWING RATE
25.71% | 200 / 778 pitches

02 / MATCHUP SIGNALS

VS. LEFT-HANDED PITCHERS

LOW SLIDER
61.54% whiff | 16 / 26 swings

OVERALL WHIFF RATE
27.86% | 107 / 384 swings

VS. RIGHT-HANDED PITCHERS

LOW CURVEBALL
65.22% whiff | 15 / 23 swings

LOW SLIDER
62.96% whiff | 17 / 27 swings

03 / PITCHING PLAN (PRELIMINARY)

ATTACK LOW WITH SHAPE
Explore sliders from both sides; RHP curveballs also generated frequent misses below the zone.

MANAGE FASTBALL EXPOSURE
Four-seamers yielded 96.29 mph average EV and .609 mean estimated contact value (88 BIP).

AVOID MIDDLE-ZONE MISTAKES
Middle-third contact averaged 95.16 mph EV and .543 estimated contact value (133 BIP).

METHOD / LIMITATIONS

Source: MLB Statcast via pybaseball; 2026 regular-season sample. Whiff rate = swinging strikes + blocked swinging strikes + foul tips, divided by swings. Location uses approximate +/-0.85 ft horizontal and batter-specific vertical bounds.
Rates are descriptive, not adjusted for pitch mix, count, pitcher quality or sequencing. Contact value is mean estimated wOBA on balls in play, not overall xwOBA. Small matchup samples warrant caution.